

INTRODUCTORY
PAPER



2019 ENGLISH

Puddles

Mum, Uncle Peter, Eddie, Jasmine and baby Mavis are playing in the rain.



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What is Mum doing?

- ☐ jumping in puddles
- ☐ holding an umbrella
- ☐ looking at the city
- ☐ standing under the tree

Who is looking up at the bird?

- ☐  baby Mavis
- ☐  Uncle Peter
- ☐  Eddie
- ☐  Jasmine

What is Uncle Peter doing?

☐

picking up a leaf

☐

chasing a duck

☐

climbing a tree

☐

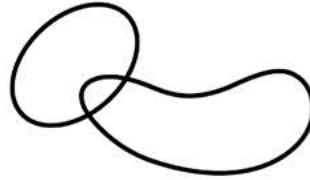
splashing in a puddle

How to draw a puppy

Before you start make sure you have these items: pencil, an eraser, a black marker pen, paper and coloured pencils or felt pens.

Step 1: Use a pencil to draw an oval for the puppy's head.

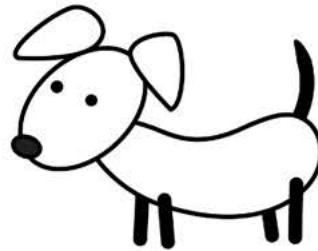
Step 2: Draw a sausage-shape to make the body.



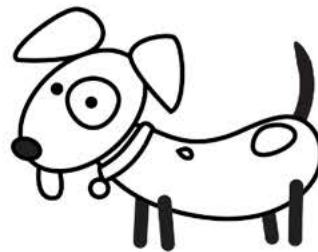
Step 3: Use the eraser to erase the 'body' line.

Step 4: Use a black marker pen to draw dots for the eyes and a small oval for the nose.

Step 5: Using the same marker pen, draw four short legs and a tail.



Step 6: Use your pencil to draw two carrot-shaped ears on top of the head.



Step 7: Draw a circle around one eye. **Step 8:** Draw the puppy's tongue.

Step 9: Draw a collar with a circle for a name tag.

Step 10: Add two patches to the puppy's back.



Step 11: Using the coloured pencils or felt pens, colour the puppy with any colours you like.

Step 12 (optional): Colour the background to complete your drawing.

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In Step 3, the word 'erase' means to

☐

black out.

☐

cut out.

☐

cross out.

☐

rub out.

'Step 11: Using the coloured pencils or felt pens, colour the puppy with any colours you like.'

Which word is a 'doing' word?

☐

'colour'

☐

'puppy'

☐

'colours'

☐

'you'

What does the word '**optional**' mean in Step 12?

☐

This is the most important step.

☐

Different colours can be used for this step.

☐

It must be completed as the final step.

☐

It is a choice whether or not to complete the step.

A → How to draw a puppy

B → Before you start make sure you have these items: pencil, an eraser, a black marker pen, paper and coloured pencils or felt pens.



Step 1: Use a pencil to draw an oval for the puppy's head.

Step 2: Draw a sausage-shape to make the body.

C →



Step 3: Use the eraser to erase the 'body' line.

Step 4: Use a black marker pen to draw dots for the eyes and a small oval for the nose.

Step 5: Using the same marker pen, draw four short legs and a tail.

Step 6: Use your pencil to draw two carrot-shaped ears on top of the head.



Step 7: Draw a circle around one eye.

Step 8: Draw the puppy's tongue.

Step 9: Draw a collar with a circle for a name tag.

Step 10: Add two patches to the puppy's back.

D →



Step 11: Using the coloured pencils or felt pens, colour the puppy with any colours you like.

Step 12 (optional): Colour the background to complete your drawing.

Which arrow points to the list of things you will need to draw this puppy?

☐

A

☐

B

☐

C

☐

D

During their last summer holidays, Rebecca and David _____ to walk on the beach.

Choose the option that best completes the sentence.

- ☐ like
- ☐ likes
- ☐ liked
- ☐ liking

However, they _____ go to the beach if the weather was bad.
Choose the option that best completes the sentence.

- ☐ would've
- ☐ weren't
- ☐ doesn't
- ☐ wouldn't

The Beach Holiday

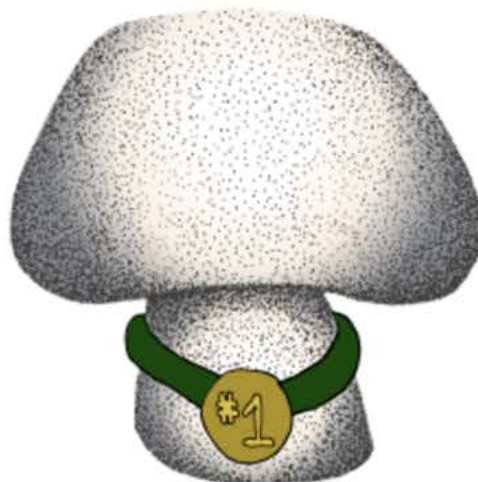


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The Perfect Pet

You may not have thought of it before, but fungi are the perfect pets. Clean, quiet, obedient and very easy to look after.

Be careful. Mushrooms grow wild all over the place—on logs, moss, in wet grass—but they can be poisonous, even fatal. The only safe mushrooms are those you buy from the shop or the ones you grow yourself from a mushroom starter kit.



Where do I get baby mushrooms?

The best place to find a mushroom starter kit is in a garden shop or hardware store. The kit will look like a bag or box of soil or compost. But don't be disappointed—baby mushrooms (called 'spores') are in there! The most common variety of mushroom in these kits is called *Agaricus bisporus*.

Where do I keep my baby mushrooms once I get them home?

They like to be in the dark, so put the kit in a cupboard with a door. Not in a place that gets too hot though, or they won't grow. They like a bit of air movement, so not in a place that is too stuffy.

What do I feed them?

There's plenty of food for them in the compost, so don't worry, they won't get hungry. But they do need a nice spray of water every couple of days to keep the soil moist.

But I can't see them!

You must be patient. It will take a few weeks for the shy little mushrooms to poke their heads through the top of the compost. When they first appear, they are called 'buttons'. Then when they grow a bit more they are called 'cups' and then when they grow even more and flatten out, they are called 'flats'. It just depends on how you like them and how big you want them to become.

What do I do with them once they are grown?

Pull them out and brush off the dirt. Then show your family and friends—they will be amazed and impressed at your perfect pet!

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'Clean, quiet, obedient and very easy to look after.' (paragraph 1)

Which word is an adverb?

☐

'Clean'

☐

'quiet'

☐

'very'

☐

'easy'

Readers are told to be careful of mushrooms because

☐

wild mushrooms can be unsafe to eat.

☐

mushroom starter kits require adult supervision.

☐

wild mushrooms grow in unclean locations.

☐

people can be allergic to mushrooms.

The way the words '**Where do I get baby mushrooms?**' are written show that they are

- ☐ a subheading.
- ☐ a caption.
- ☐ a label.
- ☐ a title.

What does the word 'variety' mean, as it is used in the text?

- ☐ type
- ☐ difference
- ☐ spore
- ☐ growth

'*Agaricus bisporus*' is written in italics to show that it is

- ☐ a translated name.
- ☐ an old-fashioned name.
- ☐ a scientific name.
- ☐ a common name.

After you've purchased a mushroom starter kit, you still need to

- ☐ replant the mushrooms in a special compost and be patient.
- ☐ place the mushrooms in a bright place and give them special food.
- ☐ find the best location and spray the mushrooms with water.
- ☐ shake off the dirt and replant the mushrooms in the garden.

Which of the following best describes how this text is presented?

- ☐ a teacher instructing students what to do
- ☐ a child learning from an expert
- ☐ a pet shop owner talking to a customer
- ☐ a parent entertaining their child

Video games are great

There is more to playing video games than some people realise. Children can learn valuable skills along the way.

Video games require concentration and determination, patience and stamina: some games take more than 100 hours to complete! They require quick responses: shooting that monster or dodging that falling block helps to develop hand-eye coordination (fine motor skills). They also require analysis, judgement and creativity to solve problems. If video games were straightforward, they wouldn't hold the attention of children the way they do.



Critics of video games say that playing for long periods harms eyesight. While it is true that staring at a screen for long periods of time can cause 'eye strain', there is little evidence that this causes permanent damage to eyesight. Everyone should take frequent breaks from staring at any screen to minimise risks.

Critics also say that playing video games stops children from getting outdoor exercise. But is that the fault of the game, or the fault of the adult in the house for not wanting to go outside? And what about interactive games where you act out the movements?

So next time it's raining and everyone is stuck inside, get out the interactive video games ... No, not golf again, Dad! It's my turn now, Mum. Mum! MUM!

When parents join in, playing video games starts to look like old-fashioned 'family fun'.

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'There is more to playing video games than some people realise.'

This sentence tells readers that playing video games

- ☐ is not enjoyable for some people.
- ☐ is not as interesting as other games.
- ☐ is not a common activity.
- ☐ is not just about entertainment.

What does the word 'stamina' mean?

- ☐ responsibility
- ☐ courage
- ☐ endurance
- ☐ performance

Which word has the same meaning as 'straightforward'?

- ☐ boring
- ☐ simple
- ☐ exciting
- ☐ expensive

According to the text, the risk of developing eye problems from playing video games can be reduced by

- ☐ spending time away from the screen.
- ☐ wearing special glasses.
- ☐ doing eye exercises.
- ☐ switching to other computer activities.

'No, not golf again, Dad! It's my turn now, Mum.
Mum! MUM!'

This quotation reveals that the writer expects
parents

- ☐ to enjoy playing video games.
- ☐ to nag their children into playing video games.
- ☐ to play video games to please their children.
- ☐ to play video games when they are bored.

What is the purpose of the text?

- ☐ to explain how video games work
- ☐ to show which video games to buy
- ☐ to convince readers that video games have benefits
- ☐ to encourage readers to play video games instead of exercising

Blackbeard's Beard

Mr Black the pirate wanted to be scary
So he grew a great beard, all thick and hairy.

To make it look worse, he set his beard alight.
'Now that,' said Blackbeard, 'will give a nasty fright.'

5 Dark smoke from his beard quickly filled the air
With the rotten-stink smell of burning hair.

'Run from the beard!' the King's men did cry,
When his blazing whiskers caught their eye.

10 'A-haargh,' said Blackbeard, 'my beard fire is the thing
to steal lots of treasure from that silly King.'

But now the scary pirate was filled with doubt.
The smelly fire! He couldn't blow it out!

He called the firemen. But they wouldn't come near.
'No way,' they shouted. 'You fill us with fear!'

15 He called for his parrot, all blue and yellow.
The parrot just laughed. 'No chance, foul fellow.'

'What to do, what to do?' Blackbeard wailed.
'I wanted to be scary, but now I've failed.'

20 He sat on the deck and began to weep.
Soon salty wet tears down his face did creep.

And the more he cried, the more his tears fell.
They soon took care of the burning smell.



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'A-haargh,' said the pirate. 'How clever am I?
I can grow a new black beard by and by.'

- 25 'And then I will set it on fire once more.
But only when it looks like rain for sure!'

Paul Mason

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'smell of burning hair' (line 6)

Which word in this phrase is an adjective?

☐

'smell'

☐

'of'

☐

'burning'

☐

'hair'

Why did the firemen refuse to put the fire out?

☐

They were too far away.

☐

They were afraid of the pirate.

☐

The fire was out of control.

☐

There was too much smoke.

What did the parrot do when it saw Blackbeard's beard on fire?

- ☐ It suggested a solution to the problem.
- ☐ It called the firemen to put the fire out.
- ☐ It refused to help him.
- ☐ It froze with fear.

Why are pictures included in this text?

- ☐ to help readers to follow the story
- ☐ to show the skill of the illustrator
- ☐ to add a different point of view to the story
- ☐ to show how sad Blackbeard felt

'I can grow a new black beard by and by.'

What does 'by and by' mean in this sentence?

- ☐ tomorrow
- ☐ immediately
- ☐ never
- ☐ eventually

'A-haargh' was Blackbeard's way of saying

- ☐ I have found the solution to my problem!
- ☐ I need your attention please!
- ☐ I think I am in big trouble!
- ☐ I am afraid of trying again!

Hi Grandma,

How are you?

Can you believe it's been two weeks since Mum and I left Sydney? Can you guess where we are from the photo? No, we're not in India. We're actually in the city of Menton in France. We're at La Fête du Citron—also known as the Lemon Festival.

Each year this unique festival has a theme and this year it's Bollywood. (This is why you might have thought we were in India from the photo.) Every year more than 230 000 visitors come to Menton to join in all the fun. There are so many people here that it feels like a party!

This festival is amazing. The lights, floats and giant garden designs make it look like a fantasy world. Everywhere I look, there is colour. During breakfast this morning, I read that the Lemon Festival started in 1935. Legend has it that the first ever lemon tree was planted in Menton. I learnt that Menton lemons are much brighter in colour than the lemons we are used to. I also found out that chefs love using them in their cooking because of their exceptional smell and sweet taste.

Guess what, Grandma? Can you believe that the designers use at least 140 tonnes of citrus fruit to create the gardens and floats. Everywhere you look there is fruit. Some of the citrus sculptures are up to 10 metres tall. That is a LOT of lemons, limes and oranges. Just imagine all the vitamin C!

Mum and I are going to be very busy for the next few days. We are going to the Garden of Lights, where all the citrus fruit creations are exhibited. We are really looking forward to seeing the Golden Fruit Parade and of course, the famous night-time parade. At the end of the night-time parade there are fireworks. I wonder if they will only be in yellow, green and orange! I hope the sun stays out as it has been snowing here. Cancelling the fireworks due to snow would certainly sour the experience for everyone.

Grandma, I can't wait to see you. Not long now—only another two weeks! I promise to send you more photos of this fruity-fun festival in France.

Lots of love,

Juliet xx



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Text: © Janison Solutions Pty Limited. Image: 85th Lemon Festival in Menton by Mandoga Media/Alamy Live News.



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'Can you believe it's been two weeks'

These words show that

- ☐ Juliet feels that time has passed quickly.
- ☐ Juliet doesn't want her grandma to worry.
- ☐ Juliet and her mother took a long time to travel around Europe.
- ☐ Juliet's grandma doesn't know the length of the holiday.

Juliet wrote 'No, we're not in India' because

- ☐ she had told Grandma that she wanted to visit India next.
- ☐ the photo might give Grandma the wrong idea.
- ☐ she thought that this festival might be popular in India.
- ☐ the photo showed traditional Indian food.

According to Juliet, which option does **not** make the festival look like a fantasy world?

- ☐ the lights
- ☐ the floats
- ☐ the garden designs
- ☐ the crowds

Which quotation about the Lemon Festival is Juliet's opinion?

- ☐ 'Each year this unique festival has a theme'
- ☐ 'This festival is amazing.'
- ☐ 'Everywhere I look, there is colour.'
- ☐ 'it has been snowing here'

According to the text, the Garden of Lights is an opportunity for people to see

- ☐ the original plans for the floats and sculptures.
- ☐ citrus fruit displays which match the annual theme.
- ☐ chefs cooking with Menton lemons.
- ☐ the first ever lemon tree on display.

Juliet wonders if the fireworks 'will only be in yellow, green and orange' because

- ☐ these colours are popular in India.
- ☐ these colours are her favourites.
- ☐ these are the colours of citrus fruits.
- ☐ these are colours that are easily seen.

Alliteration is the repetition of the same sound at the beginning of words that are close together.

Which quotation is the best example of alliteration?

☐

'No, we're not in India.'

☐

'chefs love using them in their cooking'

☐

'Guess what, Grandma?'

☐

'this fruity-fun festival in France.'

Answers

Question number	Correct answer	Mark	Category	Descriptor
1	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify a character's actions in a visual text
2	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the character carrying out an action in a visual text
3	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Describe a character's actions in a visual text
4	D	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify the meaning of a word in a procedure: erase
5	A	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify a verb in a procedure
6	D	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret the meaning of a word in a procedure: optional
7	B	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Identify a list in a procedure
8	C	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify the past tense verb to complete the sentence
9	D	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify the correct verb contraction to complete the sentence
10	C	☐ ☐	Syntax	Distinguish an adverb from adjectives in a persuasive text
11	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the reason for a warning in a persuasive text
12	A	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Recognise the layout of a subheading in a persuasive text
13	A	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret the meaning of a word in a persuasive text: variety
14	C	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify the use of italics for a scientific name in a persuasive text
15	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the next course of action in a persuasive text
16	B	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Identify the author's style in a persuasive text
17	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret a sentence that captures the main idea in an argument
18	C	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify the meaning of a word in an argument: stamina
19	B	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Identify the meaning of a word in an argument: straightforward
20	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify a supporting detail in an argument
21	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret a quotation in an argument
22	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify the main purpose of an argument
23	C	☐ ☐	Syntax	Identify an adjective in a short phrase from a poem
24	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Infer characters' feelings from speech in a poem
25	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret a character's response to an event in a poem
26	A	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Understand why illustrations are included in a poem
27	D	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Interpret the meaning of a phrase in a poem: by and by
28	A	☐ ☐	Vocabulary	Infer the meaning of an expression in a poem: A-haargh
29	A	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Interpret a character's feelings in a letter
30	B	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Understand how a photo included in a letter may be misinterpreted

Answers

Question number	Correct answer	Mark	Category	Descriptor
31	D	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Locate information in a letter
32	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Examine a letter to determine an opinion
33	B	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Identify information in a text
34	C	☐ ☐	Text comprehension	Understand why the letter writer makes a particular inference
35	D	☐ ☐	Writer's craft	Identify a literary device in a letter: alliteration

You have completed this practice test.

Your mark is

0 / 35

0%

Click here to reset the test and try again.



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